

REPLACEMENT PRODUCT VISION · V1

# Starship Cabin 2.0

THE QUIET WATCH

Awe through the glass.  
Peace on this side of it.

A restorative starship-officer fantasy for  
Meta Quest 3.

3 SEPTEMBER 2026

# The first draft was a prettier checklist. That was the wrong level of thinking.

It repeated the inherited structure—destinations, ambience, events—and renamed the pieces. It did not define why this place should matter, what makes scale believable in VR, or how we would reach a visual bar beyond procedural placeholders.

|                      |                                                                                                                                                             |
|----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| OLD FRAMING          | Build five backdrops and a selector.                                                                                                                        |
| NEW FRAMING          | Build five living windows into the reasons an officer chose this life: curiosity, wonder, fellowship, belonging and home.                                   |
| OLD CONTENT MODEL    | Loop random objects through one scene and call it alive.                                                                                                    |
| NEW CONTENT MODEL    | Give every vista its own visual composition and one authored “grace note” that arrives only after stillness has earned it.                                  |
| OLD PRODUCTION MODEL | Code a whole milestone, then discover in the headset that it does not look convincing.                                                                      |
| NEW PRODUCTION MODEL | Approve concept → build one vertical slice → compare Quest capture to target → close the visual gap → only then scale.                                      |
| OLD PURITY RULE      | Everything procedural, even when that produces toy-like hero objects.                                                                                       |
| NEW QUALITY RULE     | Use the best Quest-safe combination of shaders, authored meshes, textures, matte layers and code. Provenance remains explicit; visual quality is the point. |

**Immediate reset:** remove the blob cat; retire the “New Hope 2.0” claim; keep existing apps and branches as rollback evidence; make no more invisible headline features.

# The window should answer a quiet question: why did I become a starship officer?

Not through exposition. Through five views that let the player supply their own memories.

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## The First Question

I

Stars without landmarks. The original pull of the unknown. No spectacle is needed beyond depth, darkness and the impossible number of lights.

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## The Great Weather

II

A storm-wrapped giant close enough to humble you. Exploration as privilege: being present where almost nobody has stood watch.

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## The Long Formation

III

Other ships keeping station in silence. Fellowship without chatter; the sense that your crew and your fleet are out there with you.

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## Harbour of Ten Thousand Lights

IV

A colossal station at rest. Civilization made visible at scale: somewhere to return, repair and belong.

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## Blue Morning

V

An Earth-like horizon entering dawn. The reason service matters: fragile beauty below, and the possibility of going home.

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## The officer owns the meaning

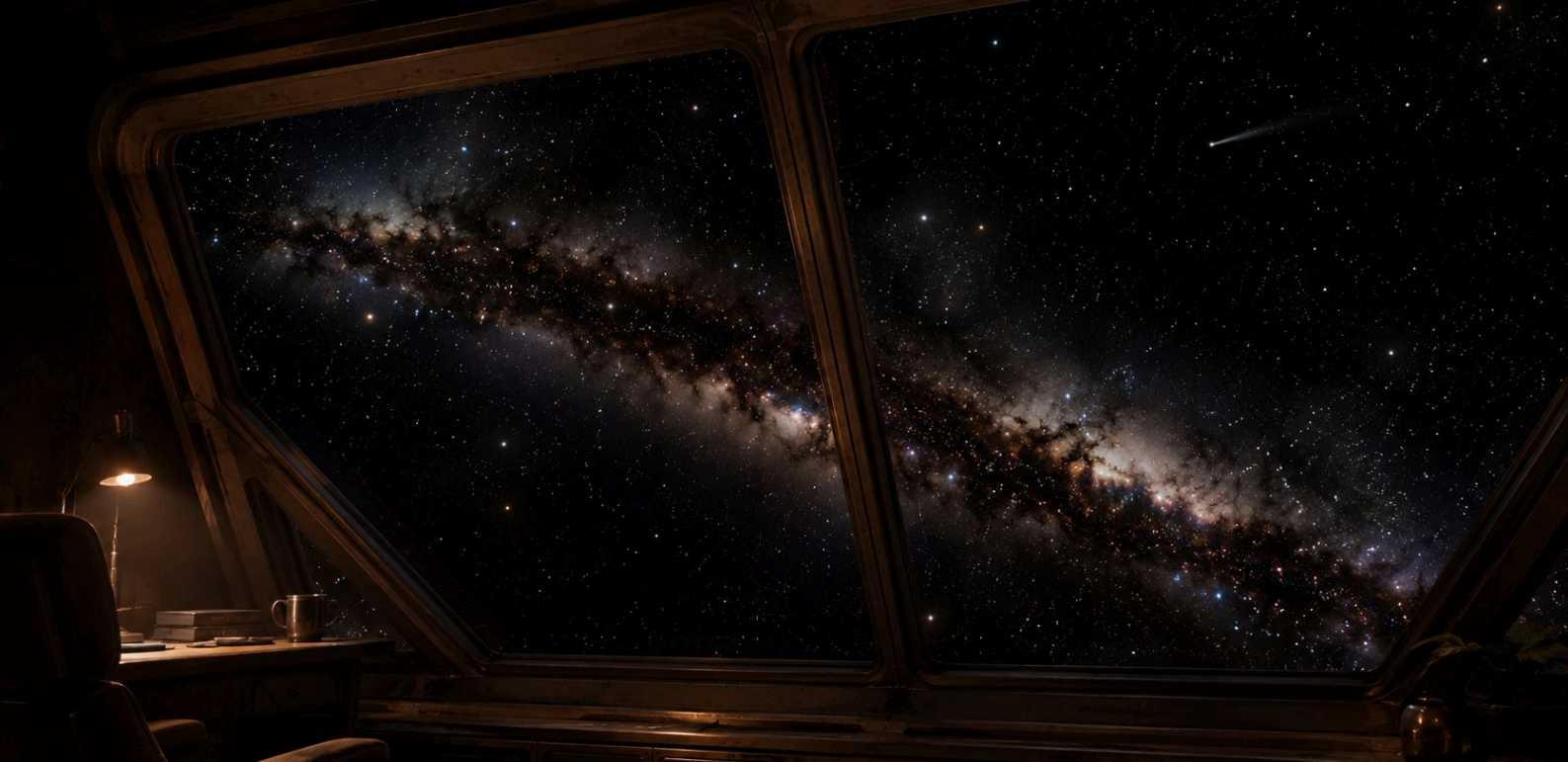
∞

No canon biography, mission text or forced voice-over. Names and atmosphere suggest a life; the player completes it.

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The room is shelter. The view is vocation.





### 03 • THE GRAMMAR OF AWE

# Awe is not “more stuff.” It is a controlled relationship between shelter, scale and time.

## 1. Shelter / vastness

The cabin stays warm, tactile and human-sized. Beyond its mullions: true black, unreachable distance and enormous forms. The contrast creates safety without shrinking the universe.

## 2. A scale ladder

Every view includes readable reference sizes. Window frame → service craft → capital structure → planet → star field. Without the ladder, a kilometre-wide station reads like a toy.

## 3. Darkness as content

Black space is not empty production value. It gives bright objects power, prevents visual fatigue and makes the room feel genuinely off-world.

## 4. Coherent causes

If a world turns, its light changes. If a shuttle passes, station beacons answer. If dawn rises, cabin light warms. Nothing drifts merely because an update loop exists.

## 5. Slow time

Meaningful change happens over minutes. Stillness is the baseline; movement is noticed because it is rare and legible.

## 6. Head-tracked depth

The view must survive small natural head movements. Near exterior elements show restrained parallax; distant bodies remain truly distant. The glass never feels like a television.

Concept target—not a screenshot. The target is the balance of true darkness, layered stellar structure, shelter and restrained light.

# Every destination is an authored period of rest, not a looping screensaver.

A twenty-minute session has a quiet dramatic shape. Nothing asks for attention; the timing simply makes staying worthwhile.

0–1:30

## Arrival

Fade through darkness. Exterior, reflected cabin light and sound settle together. The composition establishes itself immediately; no tutorial panel blocks the view.

1:30–12:00

## Stillness

The vista breathes at geological or orbital speed. Cloud bands evolve, station traffic follows routes, ships keep formation. The player can read, sit or simply look.

12:00–18:00

## The grace note

One destination-specific event arrives: a moon emerges from a ring shadow, a fleet turns toward dawn, or the station extinguishes one hemisphere for night cycle. It is composed, not randomly selected.

18:00–∞

## Rest

The scene returns to quiet continuity. No fireworks loop. The officer may remain indefinitely or choose another window.

## Only three decisions

### WHERE

#### Choose a vista

Five large, clearly different visual tiles.

### HOW ALIVE

#### Quiet / Living

Quiet preserves ambient motion but omits service traffic and the grace note.

### HOW MUCH MOTION

#### Still / Drift

Still removes horizon travel and formation manoeuvres. It is always the default for atmosphere scenes.

No forced auto-tour. No gamification, collectibles, chores, NPC chatter or “engagement” systems. This is a place to recover.

LIVING WINDOW IV

# Harbour of Ten Thousand Lights

Scale becomes belonging.

## CURIOSITY

### The First Question

Stars only, but not a flat texture: a galactic river with dust structure, colour-temperature variation, deep black voids and three restrained parallax layers.

GRACE NOTE: DISTANT COMET

## BELONGING

### Harbour of Ten Thousand Lights

A modular megastructure continues beyond the window. Habitat rhythms, docking spars and tiny service traffic make it feel inhabited and kilometres wide.

GRACE NOTE: NIGHT CYCLE

## FELLOWSHIP

### The Long Formation

Two original ship families at distinct distances. They do not patrol the window like fish; they hold station with minute corrections and shared navigation-light grammar.

GRACE NOTE: FLEET TURN

## DESIGN BAR

### No interchangeable event pool

Station actions belong to the station. Fleet actions belong to the fleet. A comet belongs to deep space. Context makes an event feel observed rather than spawned.

AUTHORED COHERENCE

Concept target—not a screenshot. The station image defines the intended composition and scale; implementation will be rebuilt for Quest constraints.





LIVING WINDOW II

# The Great Weather

A gas giant worth approaching again from first principles: storms with dimensional flow, ring shadow, moons and a night side—not six colour presets.

WONDER

GRACE NOTE: MOONRISE

LIVING WINDOW V

# Blue Morning

The emotional culmination: curved horizon, layered clouds, water and land, sparse night lights and sunrise. "Still" is an orbital tableau; "Drift" adds slow atmospheric passage.

HOME

GRACE NOTE: DAWN

The Long Formation can share this destination occasionally, but it also exists as a dedicated deep-space view.



# Do not make the headset brute-force a film frame. Reconstruct the perception of it.

Breathtaking does not require modelling the universe. It requires spending geometry, texture, motion and light where human vision reads scale.

## FAR FIELD

### Infinity and atmosphere

High-resolution sky dome or procedural star field; galactic dust; nebular haze; atmosphere scattering. Stable at infinity.

Minimal parallax  
low geometry cost

## HERO FIELD

### The reason for the view

One planet, station or fleet composition with LODs, authored silhouettes, baked detail and selective shaders.

Visual budget goes here

## SCALE CUES

### Objects the eye can measure

Moons, docking craft, windows, beacons, cloud shadow and navigation lights establish kilometres and orbital distance.

Sparse, deliberate

## CABIN RESPONSE

### The outside reaches inside

One controlled exterior spill light, restrained glass reflection and destination sound make the two spaces causally connected.

Cheap, high impact

### Reference-to-headset loop

Concept frame → PC reference scene → Quest build → fixed-seat capture → visual gap list. A milestone remains open until the largest perceptual gaps are closed.

### Performance contract

Sustain 72 Hz on Quest 3 with headroom: target CPU and GPU frame times at or below 11 ms, no thermal collapse in a 45-minute session, and no comfort-breaking stutter during transitions.

Concept art defines mood, composition and scale—not asset fidelity promises. All final assets must be original or compatibly licensed with recorded provenance.



# Prove the visual thesis before building the catalogue.

Ranges are planning estimates, not release promises. After M1, actual Quest frame time and the reference-to-headset gap determine the forecast.

|           |                           |                                                                                                                                                                         |             |
|-----------|---------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| <b>M0</b> | <b>Clean break</b>        | Create the replacement branch; remove the cat and inactive claims; preserve rollback points; implement environment lifecycle, capture positions and frame-time logging. | 2–4 days    |
| <b>M1</b> | <b>The First Question</b> | Ship the destination selector and rebuild stars-only space as the quality baseline. Install, capture and tune from every seat.                                          | 4–7 days    |
| <b>M2</b> | <b>The Harbour</b>        | Build the station first—not another planet—because it proves original art direction, readable scale, modular geometry and contextual traffic.                           | 1½–2½ weeks |
| <b>M3</b> | <b>Blue Morning</b>       | Build atmospheric horizon, cloud depth and Still/Drift comfort modes. This is the emotional and comfort-risk benchmark.                                                 | 1½–2½ weeks |
| <b>M4</b> | <b>The Great Weather</b>  | Replace the current gas-giant implementation completely; add dimensional storms, ring shadow, moons and coherent light response.                                        | 1–2 weeks   |
| <b>M5</b> | <b>The Long Formation</b> | Extend the ship language established around the station into a dedicated fleet-at-rest composition and one authored fleet turn.                                         | 1–2 weeks   |
| <b>M6</b> | <b>The Quiet Watch</b>    | Unify sound, lighting, settings persistence, transitions and living-vista timing; cut weak content; run long comfort, thermal and reliability tests.                    | 1–2 weeks   |

## GATE 1

### Looks right

Approved fixed-seat captures and headset review.

## GATE 2

### Feels right

Twenty quiet minutes without fatigue or vection.

## GATE 3

### Runs right

72 Hz minimum, transition stability and thermal headroom.

**Likely planning range:** roughly 7–12 focused weeks to a real 2.0, depending on how closely the Quest build can approach the approved station and atmosphere concepts. M1 is the calibration milestone.

# “Done” means the view survives the headset.

The roadmap is subordinate to these truths. If an implementation fails them, we change the implementation—not the standard.

## Five different worlds

Each passes a silhouette test before colour and labels. No world is a material preset for another.

## Immediate ownership

The officer can select any view within five seconds. Auto-tour is optional and off by default.

## Earned life

Motion follows the place's logic. Each vista has at most one signature grace note per session.

## Real comfort

No forced camera movement. Atmosphere and fleet views default to Still; Drift is explicit. Twenty-minute tests pass.

## Honest quality

No blob characters, primitive hero objects, invisible headline features or “subtle” excuses. Weak content is removed.

## Quest authority

Concept art is direction; on-device perception is truth. Every milestone includes an installed build and measured frame time.

## Original universe

No franchise names, silhouettes, interface language, audio or imitation. The visual identity must become recognizably its own.

The player should eventually take off the headset and feel that the real room has the wrong window.

## FIRST ACTION AFTER APPROVAL

Create a new development branch for The Quiet Watch, archive New Hope as historical evidence, and execute M0. The first installable deliverable is not another planet—it is the rebuilt stars-only view plus the real selector.